

Material Change Approval Procedure

Quality Management System · 2024-06 · Revision 3

1. Purpose

This procedure governs the classification and approval of changes affecting material specification, and sets out the record to be retained against each class of change. It applies to all product families and to all functions raising a change against a controlled specification.

The procedure does not itself confer authority. Authority to approve a change of a given class is conferred by the delegation of authority in force on the date the change is raised, and is held as described in that instrument.

2. Change classes

Changes affecting material specification are classified on the basis of the characteristic affected and the effect of the change on qualified performance. Classification is determined at the point the change is raised and is recorded against the change request.

Class	Description
Class A	Alters a characteristic affecting a safety-critical interface
Class B	Alters a qualified characteristic, no safety-critical interface
Class C	Alters a non-qualified characteristic
Class D	Documentation-only; no characteristic altered

A safety-critical interface is an interface identified as such in the approved technical file for the product family. Identification is made at design approval and is not revisited at the point a change is raised.

Where the classification is not evident, the raising function refers the change to the Quality Management System function for determination before the change proceeds. A change may not be progressed under an assumed class.

Class D covers changes correcting a drawing note, a reference, a document number or a descriptive entry, where no characteristic of the product is altered by the change. A change that alters a characteristic is not Class D however small the alteration.

3. Authority levels

For changes affecting a safety-critical interface, the following provisions apply in addition to the general provisions of this section.

Authority to approve changes is conferred in levels. The level required for a given change follows from the class determined under section 2. Levels are held by role, and the role holding each level is set out in the delegation of authority in force at the relevant date. This procedure does not name role holders, and a copy of this procedure is not evidence of who held a level on any given date.

Where authority at the required level is not available within the raising function, the change is referred upward. Authority may not be exercised by a role holding a lower level, and may not be delegated downward other than by an amendment to the delegation of authority itself. A change approved at an insufficient level is not validly approved and is treated as outstanding until approval at the correct level is recorded.

Where the delegation of authority is amended between the date a change is raised and the date it is approved, the instrument in force on the date the change was raised governs. This provision exists to prevent a change acquiring or losing an approval requirement through the passage of time alone.

Level 3 approval is required for a change of Class A.

Class	Level required
Class A	Level 3
Class B	Level 2
Class C	Level 2
Class D	Level 1

Level 1 approval is required for a documentation-only change of Class D, and may be exercised within the raising function.

4. Records

The record retained against a change is the change request itself, recording the change, the date raised, and the procedure revision under which it was processed. The classification determined under section 2 and the approval recorded against it are held by the Quality Management System function and are not reproduced on the change request.

Record	Held by	Retention
Change request	Raising function	Life of product plus ten years
Classification determination	Quality Management System	Life of product plus ten years
Approval record	Quality Management System	Life of product plus ten years
Delegation of authority in force	Corporate Governance	Permanent

Requests for the approval record against a specific change should be made to the Quality Management System function, quoting the change request reference.